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Crypto propels Trump's earnings

Disclosure reveals family firms took in at least \$2.2B in '25

By Bernard Condon
ASSOCIATED PRESS

NEW YORK — President Donald Trump reaped a stunning windfall in his first year back in the White House, including about \$1.2 billion from his family's cryptocur- rency businesses, locking in profits while his investors were socked with losses.

All told, the president pulled in at least \$2.2 billion, a figure that includes other parts of his vast holdings, such as his real estate assets. That compares with a minimum of \$622 million his enterprises pulled in for all of 2024, before he returned to the presidency.

The results, detailed in Trump's mandatory financial disclosure report for 2025 and released Tuesday, pulled back the curtain on the president's business operations. His crypto ventures are now some of his most lucrative enterprises, a remarkable turnabout for a man who once slammed crypto as a haven for drug dealers and scammers.

Mere startups when he took the oath of office, the new ventures have eclipsed in reve- nue much of his vast property portfolio built over decades. Fueling their rise were billion- aire investors and Trump's move to quash a federal crack- down on the industry.

Trump got more than \$500 million from his World Liberty Financial business selling new crypto products, including "governance tokens," accord- ing to the report filed with the Office of Government Ethics. It also showed another crypto business, CIC Digital LLC, took in more than \$600 million from sales of souvenir-type "meme" coins stamped with his face.

Both the tokens and the coins have plunged in value since the sales.

Trump also took in millions last year from selling Trump- branded Bibles, sneakers and

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Police superintendent's 3-year tenure marked by reductions in violent crime

Mayor taps department veteran to serve in role amid search for replacement

Snelling to retire



Chicago police Superintendent Larry Snelling holds his cap at the department's graduation and promotion ceremony at Navy Pier on Feb. 3, 2025. Mayor Brandon Johnson is at left. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

By Sam Charles and
Caroline Kubzansky
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

After nearly three years at the helm of the country's second-larg- est police department, Chicago police Superintendent Larry Snel- ling will retire on July 15.

"During the past three years, I have had the privilege to lead this department through the 2024 Democratic National Con- vention and a record-low reduction in shootings, homicides and violent crime," Snelling said in a statement released Wednesday afternoon. "While this happened during my tenure as Superintendent, the hard and courageous work of the members of the Chicago Police Department should be given the

credit. Though I am proud of what we have achieved, there is more to be done, and I am confident that we created a foundation for further progress."

Snelling, 57, ascended to the top of the Chicago Police Depart- ment in August 2023 after nearly three decades with the depart- ment, mostly as an instructor in the police academy. His tenure as superintendent was marked by a continuing decline in overall city gun violence, an increase in compliance with a federal consent decree, a global spotlight brought by the 2024 Democratic National Convention and the chaos that the department was foisted into during a federal immigration crackdown last year.

"He is a Chicagoan through and

through, and his career reflects a lifelong commitment to serv- ing the city he has always called home," Mayor Brandon Johnson said in a statement. "We're grate- ful for Superintendent Snelling's dedicated leadership and the work we've accomplished together to advance a community safety strat- egy rooted in strong partnerships and deep community engagement across Chicago."

The mayor tapped CPD veteran Fred Waller to serve as interim superintendent while he looks to fill the vacancy. Waller, who served in that same temporary capacity before Snelling was named to the top spot, is currently the deputy director in the superintendent's

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INSIDE Promotion to deputy

A day before announcing his retirement, Chicago police Superintendent Larry Snelling on Tuesday promoted Antoinette Ursitti, chief of detectives for the Chicago Police Department, to first deputy superintendent. The first deputy position has remained vacant since the October 2025 retirement of Yolanda Talley, the first woman to serve in the position in CPD's history. **Chicagoland, Page A4**

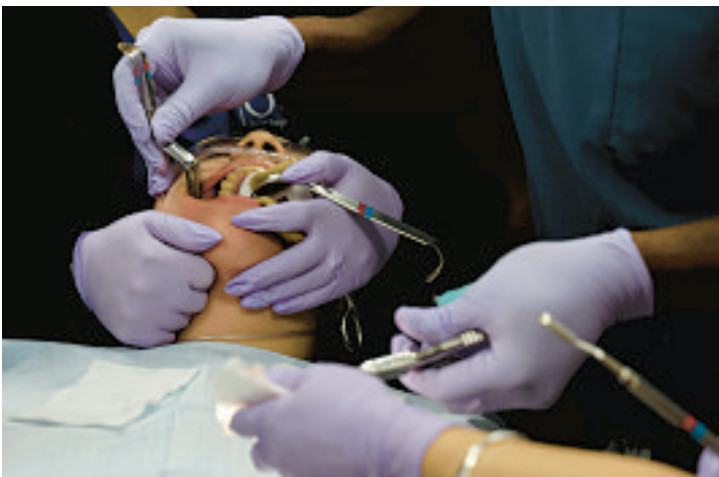
Waits drag for dental patients on Medicaid

Low reimbursements stand in way of care

By Robert McCoppin
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Erica Champ has a serious toothache. One tooth has erupted through her gum. Another throbs below the surface. Sometimes she suffers severe pain and facial swelling. She has to rinse her mouth frequently with mouth- wash or peroxide to keep the gums from getting infected.

Normally, the teeth would be removed immediately. But Champ lost her job in February of last year and had to go on Medicaid federal health insurance. She has been



Yadhira Villegas, 17, has work done on her wisdom teeth by Dr. James Appiah at Oral Surgery Solutions in Chicago on June 15. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

suffering from the condition the entire time. The oral surgeons she contacted had monthslong waits for an appointment.

She's finally scheduled to get her teeth pulled Thursday.

"The wait times are atrocious," she said. "As someone who paid my taxes into this system, I don't feel it's fair for me or anyone with public assistance to have to suffer.

It's like punishment for being poor or losing your job."

Champ, who's from south suburban Matteson, is one of more than 3 million people in Illinois — that's almost 1 of 4 residents — on Medicaid. She is typical of patients who have to wait long times for specialized dental care,

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GENERAL ASSEMBLY

Benton asked to resign amid harassment claims

By Jeremy Gorner
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Illinois House Speaker Emanuel "Chris" Welch on Wednes- day called on a Democratic lawmaker from Plainfield accused of improper conduct to resign from the General Assembly after an internal investigation revealed what Welch said were "clear patterns" of behavior that are "outrageous, unethical, and unbecom- ing of a member of the Illinois House of Representatives."

Welch also said that if state Rep. Harry Benton doesn't resign, Illinois legislative leaders will begin the process of expelling him from the House.

The speaker's statement comes months after Welch, without explanation, removed Benton from eight committee assign- ments and other House Demo-

cratic caucus duties. At the time, sources familiar with the situ- ation told the Tribune the alle- gations against Benton were of a sexual harassment nature and that the Illinois Legislative Inspector General's office was conducting an investigation.

Welch said on Wednesday that the inspector general's report was complete, that he had reviewed it, and that he had spoken directly with Benton and called for his immediate resignation.

"If he does not resign, we will initiate the process of expelling him from the House," Welch said in prepared remarks.

"The Legislative Inspector General's findings reveal clear patterns of conduct by Repre- sentative Benton that are outra- geous, unethical, and unbecom- ing

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Business 'booming' in Indiana

Illinois residents crossing the state line are packing into the aisles of northwest Indiana's fireworks stores to get their pyrotechnic fill. **Chicagoland, Page A2**

City's financial reserves shrink

Chicago ended 2025 with \$219 million more than expected in its main coffer, but the city's long-term liabilities, shortfalls persist. **Chicagoland, Page A3**

Thumbs up, thumbs down

Alex Bregman's cryptic gesture and hitless day at the plate only partially eclipse the Cubs' 23-3 rout of the Padres on Wednesday afternoon at Wrigley. **Sports**

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